JAMES HARRISON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a full stack engineer with 14 years of hands-on experience building scalable web applications and leading technical teams through complex infrastructure challenges. I've spent the last decade moving between early-stage startups and established tech companies, learning that the best systems come from understanding both the frontend user experience and backend reliability equally well. I'm particularly drawn to solving performance bottlenecks and mentoring engineers who are earlier in their careers.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Staff Engineer

TechVenture Labs

London, United Kingdom

www.techventure.io

January 2021 - Present

Led the migration of a monolithic Node.js application to microservices, reducing deployment time from 45 minutes to 8 minutes and enabling independent team deployments across five services. Designed and implemented a real-time data pipeline using Kafka and PostgreSQL that processes 2 million events daily while maintaining sub-100ms latency for critical queries. Mentored six junior and mid-level engineers, with three progressing to senior roles within 18 months through structured code review feedback and architectural design sessions. Established observability standards across the platform using Prometheus and ELK, which reduced mean time to detection for production issues from 20 minutes to 3 minutes.

Principal Engineer

DataFlow Systems Ltd

Canary Wharf, London

www.dataflow-systems.co.uk

June 2017 - December 2020

Architected a distributed event processing system handling 50 million events per day using Go and gRPC, delivering 99.99% uptime across 12 months of production operation. Rebuilt the React-based analytics dashboard from class components to hooks and improved frontend bundle size by 62% through code splitting and lazy loading strategies. Established CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins and Terraform that reduced infrastructure provisioning from 3 hours to 12 minutes and enabled 40 deployments per day without incidents. Directed technical interviews and hiring for the engineering team, successfully building a team of 15 engineers with diverse backgrounds and skill sets over three years.

Full Stack Developer

Creative Digital Studios

Shoreditch, London

www.creativedigital.net

August 2010 - May 2017

Built customer-facing web applications using Python Flask and Vue.js serving 500,000 monthly active users while maintaining 99.9% uptime and sub-2 second page load times. Designed PostgreSQL schemas and query optimization strategies that reduced average response times by 58% and eliminated N+1 query problems across the application codebase. Implemented comprehensive test suites achieving 86% code coverage, reducing production bugs by 74% and establishing testing best practices adopted by all new team members. Managed AWS infrastructure including EC2, RDS, and CloudFront, reducing monthly hosting costs by 40% through reserved instances and auto-scaling policy refinements.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2010

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend: Python, Node.js, Go, Java, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, RabbitMQ, Kafka, gRPC

Frontend: JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Vue.js, HTML5, CSS3, Webpack, Jest, Cypress

Cloud and DevOps: AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, Lambda, CloudFront), Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, ELK Stack, Prometheus

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Elasticsearch, Redis, DynamoDB

Other: System Design, Microservices Architecture, RESTful APIs, GraphQL, Agile methodologies, Git, Linux